

Storage

There are different storage solutions for different kinds of users. A person sitting at home wanting to store tons of data will need an internal hard drive while someone who needs to carry data from one place to another might opt for an external portable drive or maybe even a flash drive.



Best Performer WD Velociraptor

The internal hard drives segment has been totally dominated by the fastest hard drive there is — the WD Velociraptor. It's something we've tested a long time back and it's one drive that even challenges the highly anticipated solid state drives. We received the Caviar Black from WD but it doesn't match the performance of the Velociraptor. The WD Velociraptor goes on to win the Best Performer award of this segment. Both the 150 GB and 300 GB versions are equally fast.



Internal Hard drives WD Caviar Blue 3200AAKS

This 320 GB hard drive is a good performer. Today, prices have dropped a lot and this drive can be bought for less than Rs. 2,500. Back then, it was one of the cheapest drives around but with great performance although higher capacity drives were around for a bit more. The WD3200AAKS model like the larger WD 6400AAKS are legends of sorts.



External hard drives WD MyPassport Studio WD2000M

Those looking for portable data storage drives have the option of going for a portable external drive or a desktop external drive. The desktop versions are huge and bulky but they are large capacity drives. The portable versions are based on laptop hard drives. Among portable hard drives, we have the Western Digital MyPassport Studio WD2000M that was a good performer but was slightly low on features. A worthy mention — on the 3.5-inch side of things, the Seagate FreeAgent Desk is a basic 1 TB external desktop storage drive. It's a little light on features. It doesn't have eSATA or Firewire. In performance figures, it matches most of the other USB-based drives. Back then, it was one of the cheapest external desktop drives around — almost the same price as an internal drive. Its fancy design and build were an additional bonus. Despite this, the WD MyPassport Studio WD2000M ends up winning.



Flash Drives Kingston HyperX 8 GB

It's known to many that there are performance flash drives and there are some for high capacity. The Sandisk Ultra Cruzer Titanium 8 GB sells for Rs. 1,449 and makes good sense as compared to our best performer in the flash drive category. It's not as fast as the best performer, but still half the way there. The best performer in the test was the Kingston HyperX 8 GB. The price for the drive was some Rs. 3,633. It's a lot more than the other 8 GB drives. If you just want something that you can quickly dump data to and move on, this is the ultimate drive.